A-A-20084
October 12, 1982

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CHEESE, AMERICAN, PROCESS, PASTEURIZED; and CHEESE, PIMENTO, PROCESS, PASTEURIZED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Federal Specification C-C-291F.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers pasteurized process American cheese, and pasteurized process pimento cheese suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient Characteristics.

The product shall conform to the types, classes, and styles in the following list which shall be specified, as required, in the contract or purchase order. (Note: The list below contains common commercial pack and packaging options. Other pack and packaging options may be available and may be specified by the purchaser.)

Type I - Pasteurized Process American Cheese.

Class 1 - Sliced.
- Style A - 3 pound sliced, packed 4 units per case.
- Style B - 3 pound sliced, packed 8 units per case.
- Style C - 3 pound sliced, packed 12 units per case.
- Style D - 5 pound sliced, packed 4 units per case.
- Style E - 5 pound sliced, packed 6 units per case.
- Style F - 5 pound sliced, packed 8 units per case.

Class 2 - Loaf (wrapped and cartoned).
- Style A - 2 pound loaf, packed 12 loaves per case.
- Style B - 2 pound loaf, packed 15 loaves per case.
- Style C - 5 pound loaf, packed 4 loaves per case.
- Style D - 5 pound loaf, packed 6 loaves per case.
- Style E - 5 pound loaf, packed 8 loaves per case.

Type II - Pasteurized Process Pimento Cheese.

Class 1 - Sliced.
- Style A - 3 pound sliced, packed 4 units per case.
- Style B - 3 pound sliced, packed 8 units per case.
- Style C - 3 pound sliced, packed 12 units per case.
- Style D - 5 pound sliced, packed 4 units per case.
- Style E - 5 pound sliced, packed 6 units per case.
- Style F - 5 pound sliced, packed 8 units per case.

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The natural cheese used in the production of the process cheese shall be free of all non-edible portions. Packaging material, surface defects, unclean areas, and mold shall be removed prior to further processing.

The pasteurized process American cheese shall possess a pleasing and desirable mild to medium cheese flavor which is characteristic of the variety or varieties of cheese ingredients used. If additional optional ingredients are used, they shall be incorporated with good commercial practices, and the flavor imparted shall be pleasing and desirable. The product may have a slight cooked or acid or very slight emulsifier flavor and be free from any undesirable tastes and odors.

The pasteurized process American cheese shall have a medium firm, smooth, and velvety body free from uncooked cheese particles. It shall be resilient and not tough, brittle, short, weak, or sticky. The product shall be free from pinholes or openings except those caused by trapped steam. The cheese shall slice freely, and shall not stick to the knife or break when cut into approximately 1/8 inch slices.

When manufactured in sliced form, the slices shall separate readily and be of a reasonably uniform dimension and thickness throughout. Unless otherwise requested by the purchaser, the slices shall not be individually wrapped.

To achieve pasteurization, a temperature of 150°F is required for 30 seconds. When requested by the purchaser, the product may be pasteurized at 165°F for 30 seconds.

The pasteurized process American cheese may be colored or uncolored but shall be uniform throughout. If colored, the product shall possess a medium yellow-orange color and be bright and not dull or faded. The wrapper may be slightly wrinkled but shall envelop the cheese, adhere closely to the surface, and be completely sealed and not broken or soiled.

Pasteurized process pimento cheese shall meet all of the requirements listed for pasteurized process American cheese. In addition, the pasteurized process pimento cheese shall contain pimentos that have been chopped or diced into small particles that are uniformly distributed throughout the product. There shall be a sufficient amount of pimentos to impart a desirable characteristic flavor and comply with the applicable Standard of Identity.

Contractor's Certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves

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the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory Requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product within the commercial marketplace. The product shall comply with all regulations pursuant to the provisions of the Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act (21 CFR Parts 1 - 199).

The pasteurized process American cheese shall comply with the Federal Food and Drug Administration's Standard of Identity, 21 CFR 133.169. The pasteurized process pimento cheese shall comply with the Federal Food and Drug Administration's Standard of Identity, 21 CFR 133.171.

Quality Assurance.

The product shall be processed in a plant approved by the Dairy Grading Branch, Dairy Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA).

When required in the contract or purchase order, the quality assurance of pasteurized process American cheese and/or pasteurized process pimento cheese shall be determined by the Dairy Grading Branch, Agricultural Marketing Service, USDA. The product shall be examined and/or tested in accordance with the applicable provisions in the CID and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of solicitation, and in accordance with the requirements in the applicable regulations.

Preservation, Packaging, Packing, Labeling and Marking.

The pasteurized process American cheese and/or pasteurized process pimento cheese shall be preserved, packaged, packed, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the contract or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense (DoD) Procurements.

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer. (Copies of specifications, standards, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be

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obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Packaging.

A. Commercial packaging. Three and five pounds of Class 1 product of Types I or II or five pounds of Type I, Class 2 product shall be packaged in accordance with commercial practice.

B. Commercial packing. Not more than 40 pounds of product of one description shall be packed in one case. Metal fasteners shall not be used in the final closure of fiberboard boxes.

C. Export packaging. Same as commercial packaging.

D. Export packing. Not more than 40 pounds of product of one description only shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, or RSC-L as applicable, grade V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636; Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be constructed in accordance with style RSC or RSC-L, as applicable, class I, type SWCFI, grade 275 of PPP-B-1163; Box, Corrugated Fiberboard, High Compression Strength, Weather Resistant, Wax Resin Impregnated. Each shipping container packed with sliced cheese shall be provided with a fiberboard box liner as specified in PPP-B-636. In lieu of the box liner, fiberboard separators made of the same materials as the shipping container may be used, provided the product is separated into individual compartments. When box flaps are closed by stitches, a paperboard pad shall be placed between the sliced cheese and the stitches. The PPP-B-1163 box shall be closed with hot melt adhesive and shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. All shipping containers shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

E. Labeling (commercial and export). Labeling of cans shall be in accordance with commercial practice and be in compliance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

F. Marking of shipping containers (commercial and export). Commercial markings for shipping containers are acceptable provided the following information is included:

National Stock Number	Date of Packaging (month/year)
Item Description	Contract Number
Quantity, Unit of Issue	Name, Address, and Zip Code of Contractor

In addition, the following precautionary markings shall appear in capital letters of equal height on top of each container:

KEEP REFRIGERATED
(BELOW 45°F)
DO NOT FREEZE

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Notes:

Purchaser shall specify:

- Product types, classes, and styles, as appropriate.

Purchaser may specify:

- The temperature of the product to be cooled to 100°F or less within 24 hours after processing and delivered at a temperature not to exceed 60°F (recommended delivery temperature 32° - 45°F).

- The average age of the natural cheese used in the blend to be at least 30 days old with no natural cheese less than 20 days old.

- Melting characteristics of the product (recommended reference Tentative DA Instruction No. 918-102-3, Methods of Laboratory Analysis for Meltability of Process Cheese).

- The U.S. Grade of cheese used in the manufacture of pasteurized process American cheese or pasteurized process pimento cheese.

- The medium yellow-orange color required in the product to be alternatively described as being within the color range of 5-8 as depicted by the National Cheese Institute Cheese Color Standards.

- That the slices of the sliced cheese be wrapped individually.

- A pasteurization temperature of 165°F for 30 seconds.

- Age of product at time of delivery to first receiving activity, DoD only (recommended not to exceed 90 days from date of manufacture).

Sources of Documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Cheese Institute Cheese Color Standards may be obtained from:

National Cheese Institute
110 North Franklin Street
Chicago, IL 60606

Copies of National Motor Freight Classification and Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
1616 P Street, NW
Washington, DC 20036

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Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1-199. This three-volume set may be purchased from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

Civil agencies may obtain copies of the Commercial Item Description from:

General Services Administration
Specification Unit (WFIS)
Room 6039
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407
Telephone: (202) 472-2205

Military activities should submit request for copies to:

Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19120

Plants approved by the Dairy Grading Branch, Agricultural Marketing Service, USDA, must meet the requirements contained in the General Specifications for Approved Dairy Plants and Standards for Grades of Dairy Products. Copies of these requirements may be obtained from:

Dairy Standardization Branch
Dairy Division, Room 2963-S
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Washington, DC 20250

Copies of the U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers may be obtained from:

Director
Food Quality Assurance Division
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Washington, DC 20250

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Copies of the Tentative DA Instruction No. 918-102-3, Methods of Laboratory Analysis for Meltability of Process Cheese may be obtained from:

Dairy Grading Branch
Dairy Division, Room 2945-S
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Washington, DC 20250

Activity Symbols:

MILITARY INTEREST:

Military Coordinating Activity:

Army - GL

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

DOJ - BOP
DOT - CGS
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - FQA
VA - OSS

Preparing Activity:

USDA - DA

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